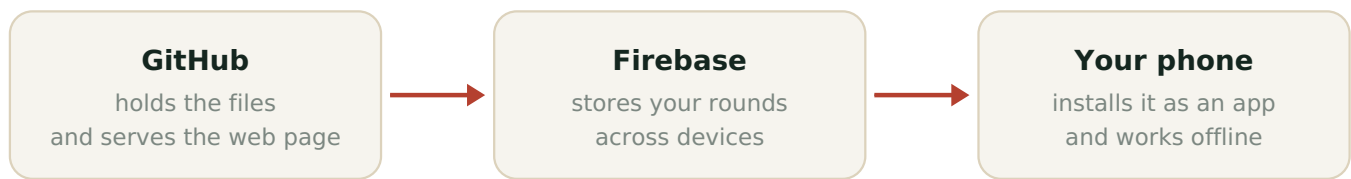


# From zero to an icon on your phone

Every step, in order, with a picture of each screen. About 25 minutes. Nothing to install and nothing to pay for — GitHub Pages and Firebase both stay free at this size.

**What you need before starting:** a GitHub account, a Google account, and the `scorecard` folder from the previous message. That's it — you can do the whole thing from a phone browser if you want to.

**The order matters.** GitHub first, because Firebase needs to know your web address before it will let anyone sign in. Doing Firebase first means backtracking.



Parts 1 and 2 are one-time setup. Part 4 you repeat on each device you want it on.

*How the three pieces fit together.*

## PART 1 · ABOUT 8 MINUTES

### Put the app on GitHub

#### 1 Create the repository

Go to [github.com/new](https://github.com/new). Name it `scorecard`. Leave it **Public** — GitHub Pages is free only for public repos on the free plan, and there are no secrets in these files. Don't tick "Add a README"; you already have one.

github.com/new

## Create a new repository

Owner \*      Repository name \*

your-username / **scorecard** 1

Description (optional)

Golf handicap tracker

☒ **Public** Anyone can see this repository. 2

☐ **Private** Pages needs a paid plan for private repos.

3 **Create repository**

Name it, keep it public, create it.

## 2 Upload the files

On the empty repo page, click **uploading an existing file**. Drag in everything from the `scorecard` folder, then commit.

**The hidden folder usually doesn't make it.** Browser uploads skip `.github/workflows/deploy.yml` because the folder name starts with a dot — on an iPad or iPhone it never uploads. Don't fight it. Upload the other ten files, and let GitHub create the workflow for you in step 3. Everything else is a normal file and will upload fine.

github.com/you/scorecard/upload

1

**Drag files here to add them to your repository**  
or choose your files

ex.html · styles.css · app.js · db.js · firebase-config.js · sw.js · icon.svg · manifest.webmanifest · firestore.rules · README

**Commit changes**

Add The Scorecard

**Commit changes** 2

Drop all eleven files in at once, then commit.

## 3 Turn on Pages

**Settings** (top of the repo) → **Pages** in the left sidebar → under **Source** choose **GitHub Actions**. There's nothing to save; the choice applies immediately.

github.com/you/scorecard/settings/pages

General  
Collaborators  
Branches  
**Pages** 1  
Actions  
Secrets

## GitHub Pages

### Build and deployment

Source

**GitHub Actions** 2

Your site will be live at  
<https://you.github.io/scorecard/>

Deploy from a branch is the other option — don't use it. The workflow file you uploaded handles publishing on every push.

Source must be **GitHub Actions**, not "Deploy from a branch".

Below that you'll see **Use a suggested workflow** with two cards. These appear whenever GitHub hasn't yet run a deployment — which is exactly where you are. This is how you get the workflow file without wrestling with the hidden folder:

github.com/you/scorecard/settings/pages

Use a suggested workflow, browse all workflows, or create your own.

### GitHub Pages Jekyll

By GitHub Actions

Package a Jekyll site with GitHub Pages dependencies preinstalled.

Configure

✗ not this one — you have no Jekyll site

### Static HTML

By GitHub Actions

Deploy static files in a repository without a build.

**Configure** 1

✓ this is exactly what the app is

Workflow details will appear here once your site has been deployed.

Clicking Configure opens a ready-made workflow file — change nothing, just commit it.

Click **Configure** on **Static HTML**. The Jekyll card is for blogs built from Markdown — not this app.

GitHub opens an editor containing a finished workflow file. **Change nothing**. Click **Commit changes** at the top right, then confirm. That single commit both creates the workflow and triggers your first deploy.

**Already uploaded `deploy.yml` successfully?** Then skip the Configure button entirely — your workflow is already there and this screen will show the deployment instead of the cards. Never keep both: two workflows publishing to Pages will fight over each deploy. Delete one from `.github/workflows/`.

## 4 Wait for the green check

Open the **Actions** tab. A run called "Deploy to GitHub Pages" starts on its own. Amber dot means building, green check means live — usually under two minutes. Click the run to see the URL.

github.com/you/scorecard/actions

### All workflows

✓ **Deploy to GitHub Pages** 1

main · Add The Scorecard · 1m 14s ago

Deployed to  
https://you.github.io/scorecard/

Green check = the app is live. Open that URL — it should load and offer to add a golfer.

**Red X instead?** Nearly always the missing workflow file or Pages source still set to a branch. Fix whichever, then **Actions → Re-run all jobs**.

The app already works at this point — offline, on this device only. Firebase adds sync across devices.

PART 2 · ABOUT 10 MINUTES

## Set up Firebase

## 5 Create a project

Go to [console.firebase.google.com](https://console.firebase.google.com) → **Create a project**. Call it `scorecard`. When it offers Google Analytics, turn it off — you don't need it and it adds a consent step.

## 6 Create the database

In the left panel find **Firestore** (recent consoles list it under **Databases & Storage**; older ones under **Build** → **Firestore Database**). Click **Create database**.

- Edition: **Standard**. Enterprise costs more and buys you nothing here.
- Mode: **Native**.
- Location: whichever region is nearest you. **This cannot be changed later**.
- Starting rules: **Production mode** (locked). You'll paste the real rules next.

console.firebase.google.com

Project overview

Build

Databases & Storage

**Firestore** 1

Authentication

Hosting

## Create database

Edition

Standard Enterprise

Database location

nam5 (United States) 2

Secure rules

☒ **Production mode** locked until you publish rules

☐ Test mode — open to the world for 30 days

3

Create

Standard edition, a nearby region, production mode. The region is permanent.

## 7 Publish the security rules

Once the database exists, open the **Rules** tab. Select everything in the editor, delete it, and paste the contents of `firebase.rules`. Then **Publish**.

console.firebase.google.com · Firestore

Data **Rules** 1 Indexes Usage

This says: a scorecard is readable and writable only by its owner.

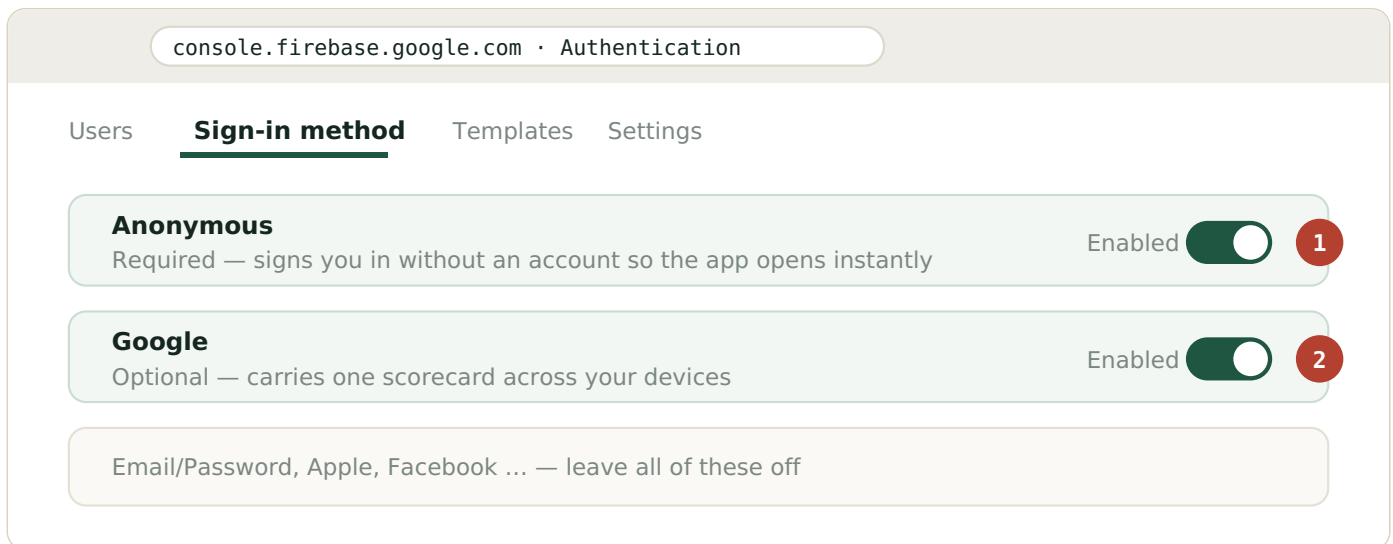
2 Publish

Skipping this leaves the database locked and every save will fail.

## 8 Enable sign-in

**Authentication** → **Get started** → **Sign-in method**. Enable two providers:

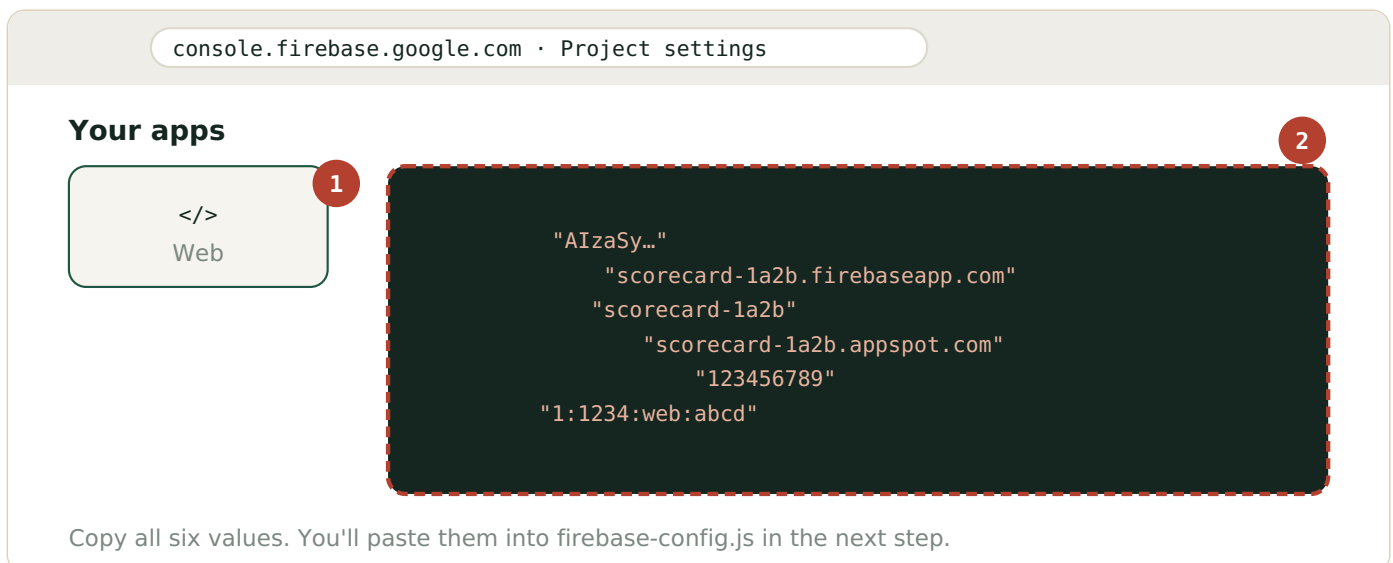
- **Anonymous** — required. This is what signs you in silently so the app works the moment it opens.
- **Google** — optional but recommended. It's how one scorecard follows you from phone to laptop. It asks for a support email; your own address is fine.



*Anonymous is not optional. Without it nothing syncs.*

## 9 Register a web app and copy the config

Click the gear → **Project settings** → scroll to **Your apps** → click the web icon `</>`. Nickname it `scorecard`, skip Firebase Hosting (GitHub is doing that), and register. You'll be shown a `firebaseConfig` block. **Copy those six values** — you can always come back to this page.



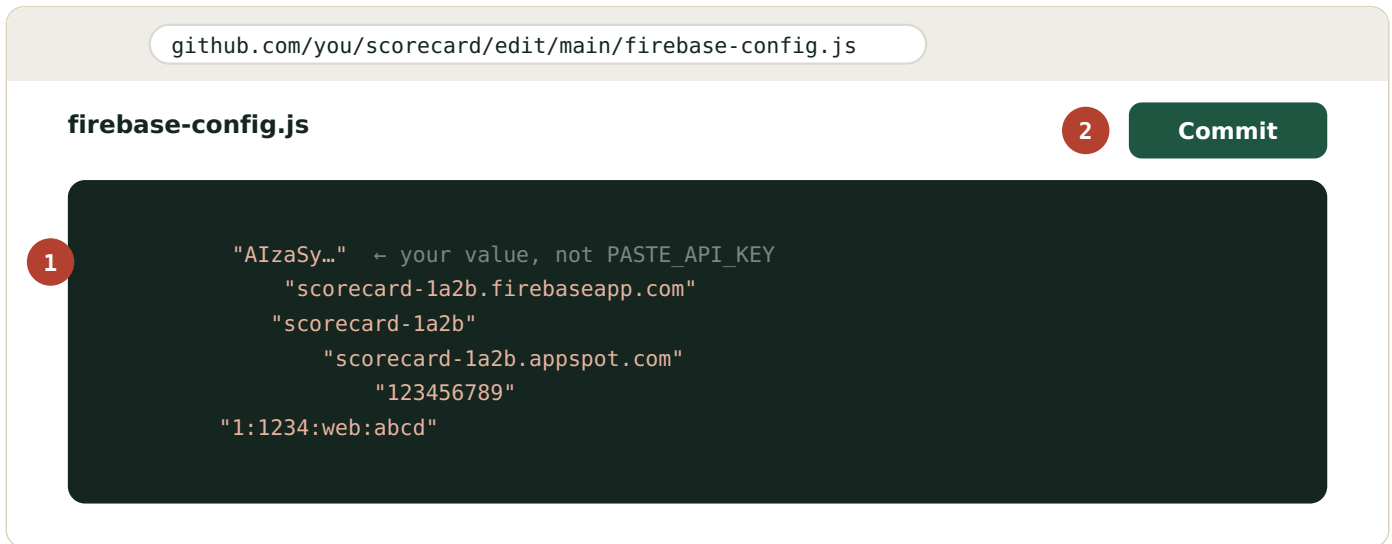
*These keys are safe to commit publicly — they name your project, they don't grant access. Your rules do the protecting.*

PART 3 · ABOUT 4 MINUTES

## Join the two together

## 10 Paste the config into GitHub

Back in your repo, click `firebase-config.js` → the pencil icon → replace each `PASTE_...` placeholder with your real value → **Commit changes**. Editing here is fine; you don't need a code editor.



Keep the quotes and commas exactly as they are — a stray comma stops the whole app loading.

Committing triggers a fresh deploy. Give it a minute.

### 11 Authorize your GitHub address

In Firebase: **Authentication** → **Settings** → **Authorized domains** → **Add domain** → enter `your-username.github.io` (just the domain, no `https://` and no `/scorecard`).



Miss this and Google sign-in fails with an "unauthorized domain" error.

### 12 Check that sync is live

Open `https://you.github.io/scorecard/`. The pill at the top right is the tell:

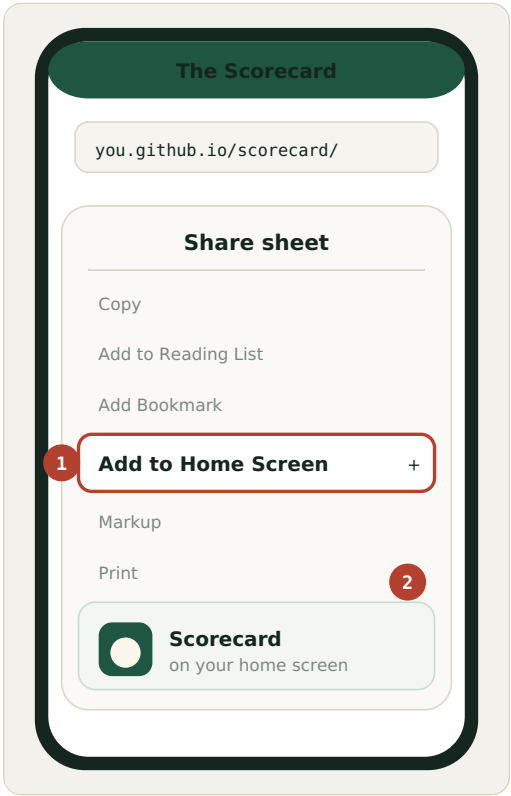
| PILL SAYS             | MEANING                                                                           |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Synced                | Working. Firebase is connected.                                                   |
| On this device        | The config still has placeholders, or the commit hasn't deployed yet.             |
| Saved on device (red) | Offline, or the rules weren't published. Rounds are safe locally and will upload. |

Post a test round, then look in Firebase under **Firestore** → **Data**. You should see `users → (a long id) → data → scorecard` with your round inside. That's proof the whole chain works.

# Install it as an app

## iPhone and iPad

It must be **Safari** — Chrome on iOS cannot install web apps. Open the URL, tap **Share** (the square with the arrow), scroll down to **Add to Home Screen**, then **Add**.



*Safari only. Once added, it launches full-screen with no browser bar and opens without a connection.*

## Android

Chrome usually shows an **Install app** banner on its own. If not: menu ( : ) → **Install app** or **Add to Home screen**.

## Mac, Windows and Linux

| BROWSER         | HOW                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Chrome / Edge   | An install icon (a screen with a downward arrow) appears at the right end of the address bar. Click it → <b>Install</b> . It then lives in the Dock or Start menu like any other app. |
| Safari on macOS | <b>File → Add to Dock.</b>                                                                                                                                                            |



you.github.io/scorecard/



1

**Install The Scorecard?**

Cancel

**Install**

Chrome and Edge on any desktop OS.

**Each device is its own scorecard** until you sign in with Google on it (Manage → Use a Google account). Do that on every device that should share the same rounds.

## PART 5

### Changing the app later

Edit any file on github.com, commit, and the workflow redeploys within a couple of minutes.

**One rule that catches everybody.** Whenever you change any file, also bump the single line in `version.js`:

```
self.APP_VERSION = "1.1.0"; → "1.1.1"
```

The service worker serves the cached copy first — that's what makes it work offline — so without a new version number, installed devices keep running the old app and you'll swear your change didn't deploy. Close and reopen the app once after a version bump.

## PART 6

### When something doesn't work

| SYMPTOM                                                    | CAUSE AND FIX                                                                                                                                                         |
|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Pages screen shows workflow cards, nothing deploys         | No workflow exists yet. Click <b>Configure</b> on the <b>Static HTML</b> card and commit it (step 3).                                                                 |
| 404 at the GitHub URL                                      | Pages source isn't set to GitHub Actions, or the deploy hasn't finished. Check the Actions tab.                                                                       |
| An error card saying "firebase-config.js couldn't be read" | A missing quote or comma in the values you pasted. Re-edit that file. The app keeps working locally meanwhile.                                                        |
| Red banner: "Firestore refused the write"                  | The rules were never published (step 7).                                                                                                                              |
| Red banner: "Sign-in isn't switched on"                    | Anonymous sign-in is off (step 8).                                                                                                                                    |
| Pill stuck on "On this device"                             | The config still contains <code>PASTE_</code> placeholders, or the commit hasn't deployed.                                                                            |
| Pill stuck red on "Saved on device"                        | Rules weren't published, or Anonymous sign-in is off. Your rounds are safe locally and upload once fixed.                                                             |
| Google sign-in opens and dies                              | <code>you.github.io</code> missing from Authorized domains (step 11).                                                                                                 |
| "Missing or insufficient permissions"                      | The rules never got published, or were pasted into the wrong project.                                                                                                 |
| No Add to Home Screen option                               | You're in Chrome or Firefox on iOS. Only Safari can install.                                                                                                          |
| Changes not showing on the installed app                   | Bump <code>APP_VERSION</code> in <code>version.js</code> , then close and reopen the app. Check the version at the foot of Summary to see which build you're running. |
| Course search says "add a free lookup key"                 | Optional feature. Manage → Course lookup → paste a key from golfcourseapi.com. Typing tees by hand works fine without it.                                             |

### Done when all of these are true

- The Actions tab shows a green check.
- `https://you.github.io/scorecard/` loads.
- The pill top-right says **Synced**.
- A test round appears in Firestore under `users → ... → data → scorecard`.
- The icon sits on your home screen and opens without a browser bar.
- Turn on airplane mode, post a round — the pill goes red, the round saves. Turn it off, and the pill returns to **Synced**.

That last one is the real test. It exercises the whole offline path end to end.

**You should never see a blank screen.** If the app can't start it says so, names the file at fault, and offers a Reload button — with the raw error tucked under "Technical detail". If only sync is broken, a red banner appears under the header and the app keeps working. Either way your rounds stay on the device.

The screens above are diagrams, not photographs — GitHub and Firebase restyle their consoles regularly, so buttons may sit in slightly different places. The names in bold are what to look for; those change far more slowly than the layouts do.

